Sahar Darafsh



Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Java backend and full stack engineer, 4.5 years in Munich, MSc in Artificial Intelligence. I build full stack features and keep the quality up with it: TDD, CI pipelines, a SonarQube gate on a large codebase, test coverage from zero to above 95%. Getting something to work is one thing, keeping it working is another, and I want both.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java · Python · TypeScript · Dart

Backend and Frameworks: Spring Framework · REST APIs · NestJS · TypeORM · Swagger/OpenAPI · Apache Wicket · Apache Tomcat · JUnit · Maven · gRPC · Protobuf (Buf)

Databases: MySQL · PostgreSQL · Flyway · Liquibase

Build, CI and Quality: Git · Jenkins · GitLab CI · GitHub Actions · SonarQube · TDD · CI/CD · Agile

Frontend: React · Next.js

Cloud and Infrastructure: Amazon Web Services · Docker · Kubernetes

Machine Learning and Mobile: Hugging Face Transformers · MLflow · LLMs (Ollama) · PyTorch · TensorFlow · OpenCV · Flutter

PERSONAL PROJECTS

LLM Listing Assistant (private GitHub repo)

- Full stack app: a seller describes changes to their electric car in a chat, a local LLM (Qwen 2.5 on Ollama) turns the text into suggested edits, and an employee confirms or rejects each one.
- NestJS and TypeScript REST API with TypeORM, PostgreSQL migrations and Swagger docs. Next.js and React frontend. Docker images pushed to GHCR by GitHub Actions and deployed on Kubernetes.

Daily Journal Sentiment Analysis (private GitLab repos)

Medium write-up

- Python service that rates a day from journal entries (English and Persian) with Transformers models and a local LLM on Ollama.
- gRPC API with Protobuf (Buf), MLflow tracking, Docker image, GitLab CI that publishes on each version tag.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer · Convien GmbH, Munich, Germany | March 2025 – Present

- Build and maintain full stack features for a meeting place optimizer with a large Java codebase (Apache Wicket, Tomcat), where high availability and sub-second response times are the requirement.
- Introduced SonarQube and lead the code quality gate on code smells, vulnerabilities and technical debt. More than **1000** critical and high impact issues when I started, zero now.
- No unit test coverage when I joined. Raised it to **95 to 98%**, and own the validation pipelines and the testing process behind project standards.

Software Developer · TESTIFI GmbH, Munich, Germany | March 2022 – March 2025

- Shipped an Android app in Flutter, then moved to backend Java to build QualityOps, a tool for evaluating and visualizing software quality metrics.
- Wrote the core QualityOps features with TDD, from stakeholder requirements, and reworked the algorithms behind them for speed.
- Worked on CAST, a cross team test automation project, which improved testing efficiency and coverage accuracy.
- Employee of the Month, March 2024, for bug resolution speed and code quality.

Deep Learning Mentor and Teaching Assistant · Maktabkhooneh, Tehran, Iran | June 2021 – March 2023

- Taught and mentored 100+ students in reinforcement learning, CNNs, neural networks and deep learning, part time next to my main job.
- Co-developed the curriculum, adding real world applications to the theory.

AI/ML Project Reviewer · Abadan University of Medical Science, Abadan, Iran | June 2020 – March 2022

- Reviewed deep learning projects in medical image analysis: model architecture choices, training procedures and evaluation metrics.
- Gave algorithmic feedback that improved model accuracy.

EDUCATION

MSc Artificial Intelligence and Robotics · Amirkabir University of Technology, Tehran | Sep 2017 – June 2020
Thesis: Designing an Embedded System for Activity Recognition using a Surveillance Camera. No public dataset existed for it, so I collected my own.

BSc Computer Engineering · Isfahan University of Technology, Isfahan | Sep 2011 – Sep 2016

CERTIFICATES

- Design Patterns, University of Alberta (Nov 2024)
- Object-Oriented Design, University of Alberta (Nov 2024)
- Agile with Atlassian Jira, Atlassian University (Nov 2022)
- Version Control with Git, Atlassian University (Nov 2022)

LANGUAGES

Persian (Native) · English (Fluent) · German (B1 telc certificate, B2 in progress)